

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Cary Crates

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist

Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with **Chip Patina**.
- Has developed mutual respect with **Frank Lloyd Wrong** despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- **Al Baster** likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Cary Crates. I move priceless objects for a living. Please do not test that sentence by handing me your drink.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Your other secret

You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Conversations to start

- Ask Chip Patina whether the minor frame damage can be repaired after the gala.
- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong which installation needs your attention before the unveiling.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A chair made of metal is sitting on information.*
- 2 *A cabinet for household supplies has accepted a mysterious new donation.*
- 3 *The highest point of the vehicle entrance conceals some information.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I cracked a minor frame during installation and covered it with a reversible mount. Grant threatened to have me fired after the gala. The repair was straightforward. Getting him to stop announcing my dismissal was less so. He had seen the damage and decided it could be useful long after it was repaired.

IF MURDERER

The crack was mine. I concealed it under a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it. Grant wanted to have me fired anyway. He could turn a repairable frame into a permanent mark against a handler. I had spent the afternoon rescuing objects he would later explain to guests as though he had installed them himself.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I was stuck in the freight lift from 6:39 to 6:45 with the damaged frame. The cabin intercom recording includes my opinion of the lift. The load camera includes me trying not to damage a second object. I got out after recovery and went back to the receiving table.

IF MURDERER

I checked the frame beside the receiving table while the freight lift was being recovered. I had left a docket in Grant's salon earlier and returned to the gallery before the toast. The mount was holding. I was trying to decide whether to show him the repair or let Chip deliver the finding.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Cary Crates

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Cary Crates

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The reversible mount is hidden in the frame, not the shipping crate. I used the preparation key for its padding and cleaned the repair with museum linen. Grant had kept a photograph of the crack. I would rather have shown the board the repaired frame than let them judge the work from his photograph.

IF MURDERER

I used the setup key for padding and kept a linen cloth after cleaning the frame. The receiving docket went to Grant's salon with the repair note. I had concealed the crack under the reversible mount. The photograph he kept made it look as though I had done nothing to put it right.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Cary Crates

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Tear off this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed a repairable crack. The freight-lift camera and intercom account for me throughout the contamination interval, with its doors shut. That recording does not improve my manners, but it does clear the murder. The mount is reversible. The damage Grant was threatening to do to my career would have been much harder to remove.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I stayed beside the receiving table while the lift recovery supplied an excellent distraction. I took the toxin on the padding cloth and wiped Grant's coupe during the docket delivery. He was going to have me fired for damage I could repair. I committed damage that nobody could.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.